



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Sally writes about her big surprise.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations

Ask your partner:

- Is there something you own that is very valuable?
- When did you find out it was expensive to buy?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about rooms and objects in them.
- I can react and comment on a story.
- I can write what I was doing when something else happened.

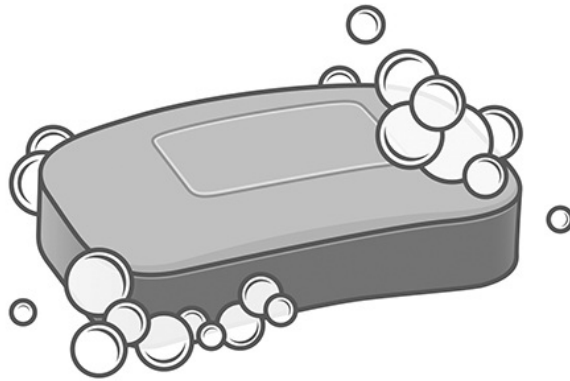




Let's Explore!

Sally writes about her valuable **discovery***. She is still in disbelief.

* A "discovery" is something you learn about, or find for the first time.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Hey readers,

You won't believe what happened. As you know, I bought a lot of interesting items on my trip to Europe. Anyway, my mother's friend, Louise, came by my apartment to drop off some tupperware she had of my mother's. She was looking at my new purchases when she spotted my miniature Greek statue in the hallway.

Firstly, I found out she is an appraiser for an auction house. Secondly, while she was talking about it, she mentioned that it was incredibly collectable. I was stunned by the news. Although she was examining a number of items, she spent most of her time admiring a painting in my ensuite.

It was very similar to one she has hanging in her living room at home. What a coincidence! She recommended that I take the statue to her auction house for a full appraisal. It may be worth thousands of dollars. I just can't believe that this is happening. What do you think? Did this happen to you before?

Sal
xox





Let's Practice!

Are you surprised?

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. How did Sally express shock in her blog about the discovery?

- ☐ What do you think?
- ☐ I was completely taken aback by her suggestion.
- ☐ Firstly, I found out she is an appraiser for an auction house.

2. How did Sally express disbelief about what she learned?

- ☐ As you know, I bought a lot of interesting items on my trip to Europe.
- ☐ I just can't believe that this is happening.
- ☐ It may be worth thousands of dollars.



Let's Practice!

The appraiser has a tour of Sally's apartment. She admires her artwork, statues and knick-knacks.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the missing word. Use: living room, mentioned, hallway, spotted, was looking, was talking.

Secondly, while she _____ about it, she _____ that is was incredibly collectable.

It was very similar to one she has hanging in her _____ at home.

She _____ at my new purchases when she _____ my miniature Greek statue in the _____.





Extension Activity

Do you or did you own a knick-knack or item that may be valuable?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research knick-knacks.
- Make a list of ten knick-knacks you can buy. How much do they cost?
- Choose three knick-knacks you like the most.
- Write three sentences about these knick-knacks. Are they cheap? Expensive?
- Read your notes aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research knick-knacks online.

☐ ☐

I make a list of items I find online.

☐ ☐

I read my list to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **coincidence** (noun): a situation in which events that are not planned or expected happen at the same time
e.g. It was a coincidence that she had the same painting.
- **ensuite** (noun): used to describe a bathroom that is directly connected to a bedroom
e.g. I hung one of the paintings in the ensuite.
- **hallway** (noun): the area between two rooms where you walk
e.g. My miniature Greek statue is in the hallway.
- **appraiser** (noun): a person who gives an opinion on the value of an object
e.g. My mother's friend is an appraiser.
- **tupperware** (noun): plastic containers used for storage
e.g. My mother's friend dropped off some tupperware.
- **collectable** (adjective): good for a collection
Example: Those statues are very collectable.
- **auction house** (noun): a place where you buy and sell items through bidding
e.g. My mother's friend works at an auction house.





Learning Points

Simple Past Tense and Past Continuous Tense

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about events that are finished. You use the Past Continuous to talk about events or actions that were happening at a time in the past.

Simple Past tense verbs can be regular or irregular.

Regular verbs end in *-ed* or *-ied*.

Irregular verbs change in different ways.

For questions in the past, you use the auxiliary *did* followed by the verb in the base form, like *Did you ask ... ?*

Did is the past form of *to do*.

For Past Continuous, you add *was/were* + verb "ing" to verbs.

Some verbs need a change to the last letter to add "ing".

Present	Past	Past Continuous
talk	talked	was/were talking
walk	walked	was/were walking
focus	focused	was/were focusing
lead	led	was/were leading
return	returned	was/were returning
have	had	was/were having
swerve	swerved	was/were swerving





Learning Points

Reacting to a Story - Expressing Shock and Disbelief

Shock is a sudden, usually unpleasant feeling.

When you are shocked, you are in disbelief.

Examples:

I was shocked to read the story.

I was stunned by the news.

She was completely taken aback by his response to her question.

I was stunned by the price of the car she bought.

The outcome came as a complete surprise.

They are all in complete shock.

Disbelief is a feeling that you do not or cannot believe or accept that something is true or real.

Examples:

I just can't believe he married my sister.

It's unbelievable that they finished the test on time.

I can't imagine they weren't able to get to work on time.

